

SECTION 1.1: Annual Salary Hike Framework

1. **Review Timeline:** Performance evaluations and subsequent salary reviews are conducted annually during the first fiscal quarter (April 1st to April 30th).
2. **Eligibility Criteria:** An employee is eligible for a merit-based salary hike only if they have completed a minimum of six (6) consecutive months of continuous service with the company prior to the review cycle start date.
3. **Performance Ratings:** Salary adjustments are strictly tied to the annual performance rating score, evaluated on a scale from 1 (Unsatisfactory) to 5 (Outstanding).

SECTION 1.2: Hike Percentage Breakdown

- **Rating 5 (Outstanding):** Eligible for a salary adjustment between 12% and 15%.
- **Rating 4 (Exceeds Expectations):**

Eligible for a salary adjustment between 8% and 11%.

- **Rating 3 (Meets Expectations):** Eligible for a salary adjustment between 4% and 7%.
- **Rating 1 or 2 (Below Expectations):** Ineligible for any salary increase. Employees in this tier will automatically be placed on a 90-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).

SECTION 1.3: Promotion and Off-Cycle Adjustments

1. **Promotional Hikes:** Mid-year promotions trigger an immediate out-of-cycle salary review, capped at a maximum 20% increase, requiring Vice President approval.
2. **Market Corrections:** Rare off-cycle adjustments for market parity are reviewed strictly in October and must be backed by cross-industry compensation data metrics.

PAGE 2: SEPARATION AND RESIGNATION PROCESS

SECTION 2.1: Notice Period Requirements

1. **Permanent Employees:** Full-time permanent personnel must provide a mandatory written notice period of thirty (30) calendar days prior to their intended last working day.

2. **Contractual & Probationary Staff:** Employees currently under probation or active short-term contracts must provide a written notice period of fifteen (15) calendar days.
3. **Notice Waiver:** Early release requests without serving the full notice period are subject to executive discretion and will result in a financial buy-out deduction from the final settlement.

SECTION 2.2: Clearance and Exit Workflow

1. **Asset Turn-In:** On or before the final working day, the exiting employee must return all corporate property to the IT and Facilities departments. This includes laptops, monitors, security access badges, and company credit cards.
2. **Exit Interview:** A mandatory 30-minute exit interview with an HR representative must be scheduled during the final week of employment to collect feedback.
3. **Full and Final (FnF) Settlement:** The processing of residual salary, accrued leave payouts, and tax documentation takes exactly forty-five (45) business days from the official last working day.

PAGE 3: LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE REGULATIONS

SECTION 3.1: Annual Leave Allocations

1. **Privilege Leave (PL):** All full-time employees accrue 1.5 days of Privilege Leave per month, totaling eighteen (18) days per calendar year. A maximum of ten (10) unused PL days can carry forward to the next year.
2. **Casual & Sick Leave (CSL):** Employees receive a fixed bucket of twelve (12) combined Casual and Sick leaves per year, allocated on January 1st. CSL balances cannot be carried forward and expire completely on December 31st.

SECTION 3.2: Booking and Approvals Workflow

1. **Prior Intimation:** Any planned leave exceeding three (3) consecutive working days must be submitted via the internal HR portal at least two weeks in advance.
 2. **Medical Certification:** For unplanned sick leave extending beyond three (3) consecutive days, employees must submit a valid medical certificate signed by a registered healthcare professional upon returning to work.
 3. **Unexcused Absences:** Absence from work for five (5) consecutive days without active managerial notification or portal submission will be treated as voluntary abandonment of service, triggering immediate termination proceedings.
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3. Place the file inside your data/ or company_policies_folder/ directory.

Once you have your PDF file ready on your system, let me know. We will then move directly to **Phase 2: Setting up the Ingestion Pipeline to chunk this text and save it to your Chroma Vector DB**, completely hooked up to your **Python Logger**.

Are you **ready to start setting up the Ingestion script**, or do you need help writing the script to convert this text to PDF first?